

Security at AI Speed

Implementing Security at Machine Speed: How to Move Fast Without Breaking the Business

Act Now (0–3 months)

Governance

- Establish continuous, business-aligned governance baseline
- Define risk ownership and decision rights
- Set AI guardrails and initial oversight model

Organisation & Culture

- Clarify roles (CISO, SOC, data, AI ownership)
- Create cross-functional working model (security + business)
- Start leadership alignment (board/executive engagement)

SOC / SecOps

- Stabilize current SOC operations
- Remove manual bottlenecks in triage
- Define “minutes matter” KPIs

Architecture

- Define target architecture principles (Zero Trust, data-centric)
- Identify critical gaps (identity, telemetry, integration)
- Align to reference architecture and roadmap

Identity / Access

- Enforce phishing-resistant MFA (or equivalent baseline)
- Reduce obvious privilege risks
- Centralize policy enforcement approach

Data / Visibility

- Start centralizing logs (initial data lake)
 - Identify crown-jewel data
 - Begin classification approach
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Short Term (6–8 months)

Governance

- Operationalize governance as a continuous cadence
- Integrate cyber risk into business risk processes
- Establish measurable KPIs and reporting

Organization & Culture

- Formalize operating model (RACI, workflows)
- Build security-as-enabler mindset
- Embed security into transformation programs

SOC / SecOps

- Introduce AI-assisted detection and investigation
- Integrate threat intelligence and business context
- Reduce response time towards “minutes”

Architecture

- Implement core architecture building blocks
- Start integrating identity, data, and SOC layers
- Establish security design standards

Identity / Access

- Move towards adaptive, risk-based access
- Introduce least privilege as enforced control
- Integrate identity into all critical systems

Data / Visibility

- Mature data lake (coverage, quality, correlation)
- Introduce graph-based relationships (if applicable)
- Enable cross-domain visibility (identity, endpoint, cloud)

Mid Term (9–12 months)

Governance

- Mature governance into decision engine for prioritisation
- Align regulatory, business, and operational governance
- Introduce continuous improvement loops

Organization & Culture

- Fully integrated security-business collaboration
- Security embedded in product, IT, and transformation teams
- Strong accountability culture across domains

SOC / SecOps

- Transition to proactive / pre-breach operations
- Automate large parts of investigation and response
- Integrate AI agents for assisted or autonomous actions

Architecture

- Move to integrated, end-to-end security architecture
- Eliminate silos between domains
- Align architecture to business critical services

Identity / Access

- Identity becomes primary control plane
- Full Zero Trust enforcement across environments
- Extend identity to workloads, APIs, and AI agents

Data / Visibility

- Fully operational security data platform
 - High-fidelity correlation and anomaly detection
 - Support predictive and pre-emptive use cases
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Beyond (12+ months)

Governance

- Governance becomes adaptive and predictive
- Fully embedded in enterprise decision-making
- Real-time risk visibility and trade-off decisions

Organisation & Culture

- Security operates as strategic business enabler
- Continuous learning organisation
- Strong resilience and crisis-readiness culture

SOC / SecOps

- “Machine-speed SOC” fully realised
- Autonomous or semi-autonomous response capabilities
- Continuous collaboration with external ecosystem (collective defense)

Architecture

- Dynamic, adaptive architecture
- Security embedded by design across all systems
- Continuous evolution with threat landscape

Identity / Access

- Identity-driven security for all entities (humans, machines, AI)
- Continuous verification and least privilege enforcement
- Seamless integration across enterprise ecosystem

Data / Visibility

- Real-time, organization-wide visibility
- Predictive analytics and automated decisioning
- Full integration into SOC and governance